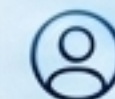


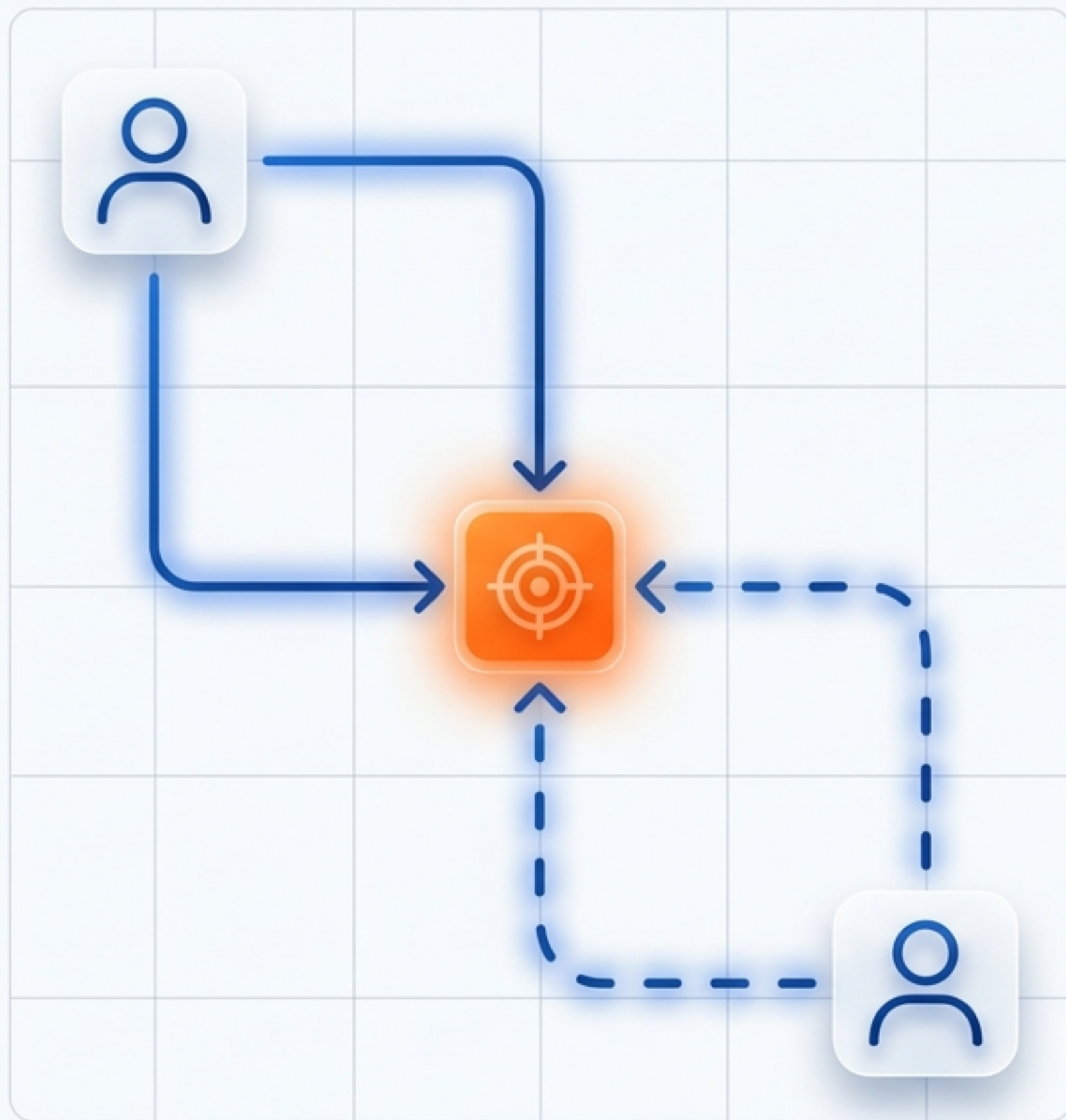


Writing Clear, Reproducible Steps

So anyone can follow your test.



Prepared by Nkiru (Justy) · Manual QA Tester



The Core Concept: What is Reproducible?

A step only you can follow is a private memory.
A reproducible step is a professional artifact.



Definition: An instruction specific enough that two different people, acting on it independently, perform the identical action and arrive at the identical state.



Remember: It's not about writing more words; it's about removing every place a reader has to guess.

The Anatomy of a Well-Written Step



Atomic

Does exactly one thing. (Never two actions hiding in one).

Imperative

Direct command using an action verb.

Specific

Names the exact element, field, or value.

Ordered

Numbered in the exact sequence they must occur.

Self-Contained

Includes data inline or points to Test Data.



Remember: Missing even one of these five qualities is usually where a developer says "Could not reproduce."

Language Conventions That Remove Ambiguity



Platform-Correct Verbs

- Use Tap for touchscreen/mobile.
- Use Click for desktop/mouse.
- Don't mix them to avoid misleading context.



Present-Tense Imperative

- Always use direct commands: Enter, Select, Scroll.
- Never use past tense or narrative.



Name the Element

- Specify the exact UI control.
- Example: Click the orange Confirm button, not just click the button.



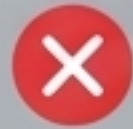
Observable Results

- State exactly what should be checked.
- Keep judgments out of the steps.



Remember: Keep test data separate but linked. Never write "enter the email from before."

Comparison Matrix: Vague vs. Reproducible



Vague



Reproducible

Login Example

Try logging in with wrong details and see what happens.

1.  **Navigate** to /login.
2.  **Enter** qauser@demo.com in Email.
3.  **Enter** WrongPass99! in Password.
4.  **Click** Log In.

Mobile Booking Example

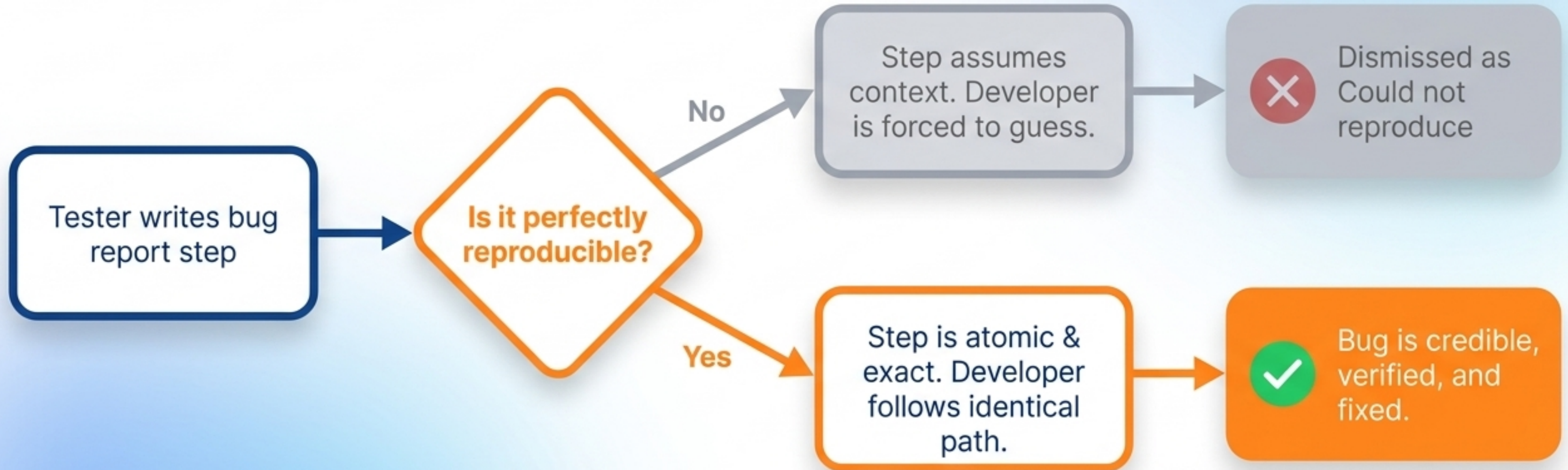
Click the date and leave it empty, then submit.

1.  On Booking screen, **tap** Date.
2.  **Close** date picker without selecting, leaving it empty.
3.  **Tap** Confirm Booking.



Remember: Replace judgment words like "try" or "see what happens" with concrete actions.

Workflow Diagram: The Lifespan of a Test Step



Remember: A bug is only as strong as the steps behind it. Reproducibility is the entire value a QA tester adds.

Diagnostic Checklist: Common Mistakes

Mistakes

-  ~~Bundling actions (Enter email and password and click login)~~
-  ~~Using Observe as a user action.~~
-  ~~Leaving out starting conditions.~~
-  ~~Describing the bug inside the steps.~~

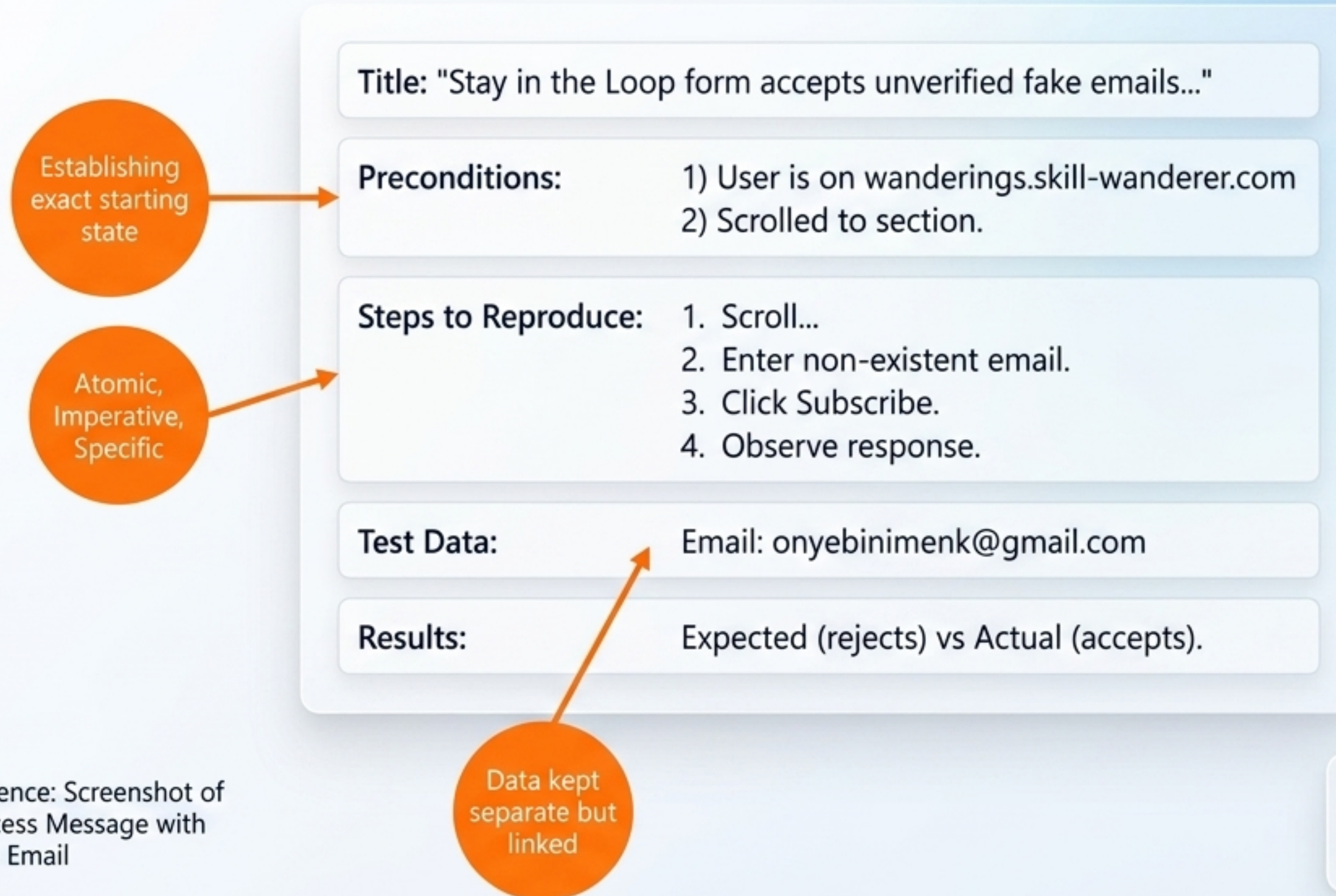
Corrections

-  Break into 3 separate, numbered steps.
-  Observation is the result of a step, not an execution.
-  Always define preconditions before Step 1.
-  Keep steps entirely neutral. State the issue separately.



Remember: Write steps for a stranger who has never seen your screen, not from your own memory.

Worked Example: Deconstructing a Real Bug Report



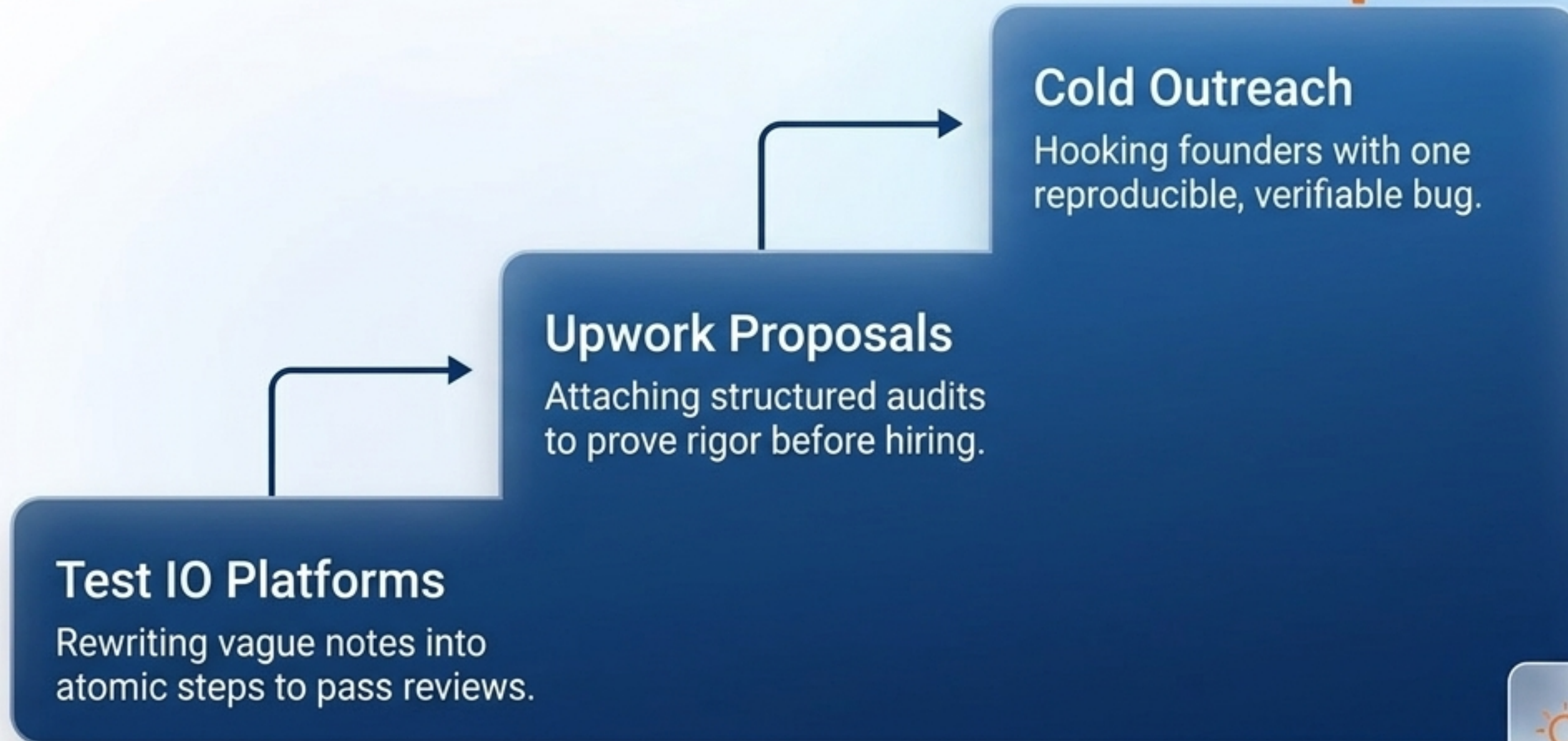
Evidence: Screenshot of Success Message with Fake Email



Remember: The goal is evidence so solid that no one needs to take your word for it.

Timeline: Building Professional Trust

Professional Trust



Remember: Reproducibility is the fundamental unit of trust in freelance QA work.

Key Takeaways Summary



The Ultimate Test

A total stranger must be able to follow your instructions and land in the identical state, without your help.



The 5-Part Anatomy

Every step must be Atomic, Imperative, Specific, Ordered, and Self-Contained.



Language Rules

Always use platform-correct verbs (Tap vs. Click) and present-tense imperatives (Enter, Select).



Avoid Anti-Patterns

Never bundle multiple actions into a single step, and never assume context.



Remember: Review these four pillars before submitting any bug report.

Interactive Knowledge Check

Q1: What defines a reproducible step?

 **An instruction where two independent people arrive at the identical state.**

Q2: Which of the following is an imperative action verb?

 **Click**

Q3: What is the most common beginner mistake?

 **Bundling multiple actions into one step.**

Q4: What is the correct platform verb for a mobile touchscreen?

 **Tap**

Q5: Where should specific testing values go?

 **Inline, or in a clearly labelled Test Data section.**



Remember: Mastery comes from consistently applying these basic rules.

Before this lesson, I thought writing steps just meant describing what I did. I now understand it means removing myself from instructions entirely — writing so precisely that my own presence is not required for someone else to see exactly what I saw.

– Nkiru (Justy), Manual QA Tester



Remember: Your absence is the ultimate proof of a perfectly written step.



Thank You.

Ready to write flawless test steps?

